

Lesson 9: You Have to Demonstrate Loyalty to Receive It

Joan Cronan

In today's fast-paced world, businesses face fierce competition and constant challenges. And to thrive in such an environment, employees need to be dedicated and committed employees who share their vision and their values. Loyalty from employees translates into increased productivity, reduced turnover, and a competitive work culture. When employees feel valued and supported, they are more motivated to invest their skills and contribute meaningfully to the organization's success. They are also more likely to go the extra mile to be passionate ambassadors for the company.

But despite its significance, loyalty seems to be a diminishing principle in today's workplace. In the pursuit of profit and growth, some organizations prioritize short-term gains over long-term relationships with employees. Downsizing, outsourcing, and frequent restructuring can leave employees feeling dispensable and undervalued. Similarly, employees may view employers primarily as steppingstones to advance their careers, leading to a lack of commitment and loyalty.

So, how can we cultivate loyalty in the workplace? It begins with a two-way street of appreciation between employees and employers. Nurturing a loyal workforce requires creating a culture that values people over profit. Encouraging work-life balance, promoting employees' well-being, and offering flexibility are essential aspects of this. Employers can also demonstrate loyalty by providing:

- Competitive compensation
- Benefits
- Opportunities for growth and development

On the other hand, employees can exhibit loyalty by:

- Maintaining a positive attitude
- Operating with integrity
- Avoiding gossip
- Giving 100% on the job

No matter what product or service you're offering, an organization is only as good as its people. Everything begins and ends with the people you have on your staff. Coach Summit knew this and prioritized loyalty highly among her favorite Definite Dozen leadership principles. You know, when I think of Pat and how she worked with her staff, it was incredible. Never, ever did she just assume they were there to help her. She always assumed that they were to work

together. You know, one time we won a championship and I was so excited that when we came back for the celebration, I was able to get a Mercedes for Pat to drive for a year for winning a championship. So we presented it at the celebration and everybody was thrilled. Well, the next year when Pat and I were visiting about if we might win a championship or when we would win a championship, she said, let's do something for our assistants. So I got a Mercedes for all three assistants because all of them had been there for the three previous championships. It was so much fun to watch Pat enjoy her assistants get excited.

In short, loyalty in the workplace is not just an abstract concept, but a tangible force that influences an organization's success. By cultivating loyalty to employers and employees alike, we create an ecosystem of dedication that propels our businesses to new levels. Loyalty is not just about staying at an organization, but about profound commitment to thrive together.